

FLL Code Management — SPIKE Prime

FIRST LEGO League · BIOGLOW (2026-27) · for STEM4U coaches — TurtleBricks & OrcaBricks

Why this matters: FLL robots run on **LEGO Education SPIKE Prime** (SPIKE App — Word Blocks or Python; projects save as `.llsp3`). SPIKE has **no cloud sync and no version control**, so your team's code lives on whatever device you used. One dead laptop = a lost season. This routine prevents that.

The four golden rules

1

One team device

Keep the robot code on a single designated laptop or tablet (or one shared team account). Don't scatter copies across kids' devices.

2

Export & back up every session

At the end of every meeting, export the `.llsp3` project and upload it to the team's shared Drive folder. This is the habit that saves your season.

3

Name with date + version

Team_BIOGLOW_YYYY-MM-DD_what.llsp3 — e.g. TurtleBricks_BIOGLOW_2026-09-12_M11-v3.llsp3. Never overwrite; keep the last several so you can roll back.

4

Document the *why* in the notebook

Judges score the coding *journey*, not just the final program. Record decisions, what failed, and what you changed in the Engineering Notebook.

How to back up (30 seconds, every session)

- In the SPIKE App, open the project → **menu (...)** → **Save a copy / Export** → save the `.llsp3` file.
- Upload it to your team's Drive folder: STEM4U Robotics ▶ [Team] ▶ Code .
- Use the dated name. **Keep the last several versions** — don't overwrite the old one.

Recommended shared-Drive folder structure

```

STEM4U Robotics/
├── FLL – BIOGLOW 2026-27/
│   ├── TurtleBricks/
│   │   ├── Code/           ← dated .llsp3 exports (keep every version)
│   │   ├── Robot design/   ← photos, attachment plans, CAD
│   │   ├── Notebook/       ← Engineering Notebook drafts
│   │   └── Innovation Project/
│   ├── OrcaBricks/
│   │   └── (same four folders)
│   └── Shared/

```

Word Blocks vs Python

- **Word Blocks** — start here for most Gr 3–6 teams. Visual, fast, forgiving.
- **Python** — for teams ready for text; same robot, better for complex logic.
- Keep **one canonical project** per robot configuration — don't fork into stray files.

Don't

- Don't rely on the SPIKE app's local storage as your *only* copy.
- Don't use Git for `.llsp3` — they're zipped/binary and won't diff or merge. Dated Drive files are the way.
- Don't let each kid keep a private copy of "the" competition program — chaos on tournament day.

SPIKE App: spike.legoeducation.com · Prepared for STEM4U coaches. Back up every session — future-you will thank present-you.